

# STATE OF NEW YORK

9560--A

## IN ASSEMBLY

January 14, 2026

Introduced by M. of A. BERGER -- read once and referred to the Committee on Higher Education -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the education law, in relation to enacting the "building retention and internship-to-degree graduate employment (BRIDGE) act"

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

1 Section 1. Short title. This act shall be known and may be cited as  
2 the "building retention and internship-to-degree graduate employment  
3 (BRIDGE) act".

4 § 2. Subdivision 2 of section 7705 of the education law is renumbered  
5 subdivision 3 and a new subdivision 2 is added to read as follows:

6 2. (a) Notwithstanding any provision of law to the contrary, an appli-  
7 cant who has completed at least four hundred fifty hours of the field  
8 work component in a master of social work program registered by the  
9 department may apply for a limited permit in accordance with the  
10 provisions of this subdivision.

11 (b) Such limited permit shall:

12 (i) be issued upon submission of an application prescribed by the  
13 department;

14 (ii) require certification, on such application, by a supervisor  
15 licensed and qualified under this article, attesting that the supervisor  
16 agrees to oversee the permittee and authorizes the permittee to continue  
17 providing care within the supervisor's practice or agency upon issuance  
18 of the limited permit;

19 (iii) become effective immediately upon the applicant's graduation  
20 from the master of social work program; and

21 (iv) authorize the permittee to practice only under the supervision of  
22 such supervisor and only in accordance with the commissioner's regu-  
23 lations.

24 (c) Limited permits issued under this subdivision shall be valid for  
25 the same period as a limited permit issued in subdivision one of this  
26 section.

27 § 3. This act shall take effect on the one hundred twentieth day after  
28 it shall have become a law.

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets  
[-] is old law to be omitted.

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